

Fly GACA — Monetization Strategy

SECTION 03-finance

TYPE strategy

STATUS **active**

OWNER Founder

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Status: **adopted June 2026; price card re-cut 2026-08-19**. This document is the commercial source of truth for pricing and the revenue plan.

`src/pages/pricing/Pricing.tsx`, `src/lib/prepCatalog.ts`, `.env.example` and the ROADMAP price sheet must match the price card below — and in the product repo `tests/pricing-server-parity.test.ts` enforces it. The companion operational playbook for the B2B motion is `07-gtm/b2b-pipeline.md`.

Where we are

The site is in **launch mode** — **everything is free for everyone** (`FREE_FOR_EVERYONE` in `src/lib/services/entitlements.ts`). The entire billing machine is built or specified and dormant: Moyasar checkout to be integrated at the paywall flip (**gateway of record: Moyasar**), B2B seat grants (`server/src/routes/grants.ts`), the Captain Adel free-tier quota (`server/src/chat-quota-core.ts`), and entitlement gating (`src/lib/services/features.ts`). Stripe was never shipped and the code no longer exists; RevenueCat iOS IAP remains unimplemented.

[Owner to confirm] — the production stack (the Functions-era services, not the Express service) carries live `MOYASAR_PRICE_*_SAR` values including a Student tier. Whether the paywall is genuinely dormant in that deployment, or only in the current source tree, has not been verified; confirm before restating "everything is free for everyone" externally.

Online checkout cannot open until the legal entity exists (ROADMAP P0-3). Schools, however, can be quoted and invoiced manually today — so the revenue plan is sequenced B2B-first.

Guiding rule — never paywall the regulations

Unchanged and non-negotiable: the GACAR library, the guides and the safety lessons stay free forever. They are the SEO funnel, the trust-builder and the safest legal posture. Fly GACA charges for the **tools, teaching and AI** that act on the regulations — never for reading the law.

Market benchmarks (June 2026)

Prices observed for comparable products (1 USD $\approx$ 3.75 SAR):

Comparable	Price	$\approx$ SAR
Boldmethod (study subscription)	\$14.99/mo	~56/mo

Comparable	Price	≈ SAR
ChatGPT Plus (AI-tutor WTP anchor)	\$20/mo	~75/mo
Bristol Groundschool question bank	€31/mo	~135/mo
ATPL Training (QB + AI tutor)	from €9.90/mo	~43/mo
Gleim FAA test-prep bundle	\$49–99 one-time	185–370
ASA Prepware (per test)	\$59–69 one-time	220–260
King Schools / Sporty's course	\$179–349 one-time	670–1,310
ForeFlight Basic/Pro/Performance	\$120/\$240/\$360 per yr	450/900/1,350 per yr
CPL at OxfordSaudia (context, not a competitor)	—	~120,000 total

The economics that matter: a Saudi cadet spends ~SAR 120,000+ on a CPL. A failed written exam or a delayed checkride costs more than a year of any study tool. Willingness to pay is anchored by the global study-subscription band (Boldmethod/ChatGPT ≈ SAR 55–75/mo), not by the cost of the content.

Price card (SAR) — the decided numbers

*Effective 2026-08-19. Every figure below is **VAT-inclusive**, as ZATCA requires of a published consumer price. This card is the commercial statement of what `ay2m/FLyGACA` is **intended** to charge — the technical source of truth is `PRICE_*` on the Express Cloud Run revision, held to the displayed price by `tests/pricing-server-parity.test.ts`. **Change one, change both.***

[!CAUTION] **Target card, not the live card.** The Express service that reads `PRICE_*` has **never been deployed** (verified against `gcLOUD`, 2026-08-19 — see [../06-operations-it/hosting-facts.md](https://github.com/06-operations-it/hosting-facts.md)). Production is still the previous Firebase Functions stack, which prices from the **old** `MOYASAR_PRICE_*_SAR` env names and is therefore **still charging the old card**:

Item	Live today (old card)	Target (card below)
Pro monthly / annual	59 / 349	79 / 649
Student tier	39 / 299 — still live in production	Retired — no Student tier
Exam Season Pass	149	299
Exam-prep packs	49 / 79	249 / 399 / 499 (three bands)
All-Access Bundle	199	1,499
Captain Adel credits	19	39

The re-cut card takes effect only when the Express service ships. Until then: **do not quote the card below to a customer, a school or an investor as the current price**, and treat any revenue model built on it as a post-migration projection. The Student tier in particular is a live SKU that the target card does not contain — retiring it is a customer-facing change that needs its own decision and comms, not a silent cutover.

Subscriptions

Item	Price	Why
Pro Monthly	79/mo	Mid-band against the AI-instructor comparables (SAR 49–187/mo) and just above the Saudi consumer-subscription corridor, where a professional tool should sit. The monthly is the anchor, not the product.
Pro Annual	649/yr (≈54/mo, save 32%)	Pulls cash forward and locks a training year. Still under the SAR 860–960 band a full-year EASA question bank commands, and a fraction of the SAR ~1,970 a Gulf pilot already pays for Jeppesen Middle East charts. 7-day free trial.
Exam Season Pass	299 one-time, 90 days	Matches the fixed-window convention this market actually uses (BGS 90-day ≈ SAR 344, ATPLQuestions 2-month ≈ SAR 343). Priced so the annual is the obvious upgrade for anyone with more than one exam ahead.
Captain Adel credits	39 · 50 answers	Tops up beyond the free daily allowance without a subscription.

Exam-prep packs (one-time, permanent ownership; official GACA/testing fees never included)

Packs price in three bands by how much material each carries — not by certificate-vs-subject label, which put a 76-question pack and a 514-question pack at the same price.

Band	Price	Packs
Essential	249	Conversion · Medical · AIP

Band	Price	Packs
Standard	399	ELP/SAELPT · ATPL · IR
Complete	499	CPL · PPL
All-Access Bundle	1,499	All eight paid packs, permanent — under half the price of buying them separately

The entry band sits at the international question-bank floor (ASA/Dauntless/Sheppard ≈ SAR 188–244 per written) and inside the Saudi one-time edtech band (SAR 199–400). `airspace-vfr` stays **free** as the sampler.

Fly GACA for Schools (B2B) — annual packages, not per-seat bands

Tier	Price	What it covers
Cohort	12,000/yr	Up to 25 seats, one 90-day intake — 480/seat/yr . Self-serve checkout.
Academy	39,000/yr	Up to 100 seats, rolling 12 months (~390/seat/yr). Contact sales.
Institution	from 72,000	100+ seats, SSO. Contact sales.

Publishing these is deliberate: in flight-school software almost every vendor is quote-only, so a visible price is an acquisition edge. Seat economics hold up against the alternative — 25 cadets each buying a foreign course at SAR 930–1,120 is SAR 23k+.

Licensed Captain Adel API (`/v1/ask`) — metered, per calendar month

Tier	Price	Included answers
Starter	499/mo	1,000
Growth	1,999/mo	5,000
Scale	6,999/mo	25,000
Enterprise	custom	uncapped · SLA

Priced at roughly 24× the cost of serving a cited answer, between commodity answer APIs and niche regulatory-data APIs — where a first-party corpus belongs.

The free tier stays: library free forever, all 55 flight tools, **5 Captain Adel questions per day** (3/day signed-out), one free prep pack, all guides free.

There is no Student tier. It charged less than Pro for an identical entitlement and its eligibility check was never wired to any route, so it was strictly the better buy for everyone and Pro's price was decorative. Removed 2026-08-19 rather than gated.

The plan — three phases

Phase A — B2B now (the only invoice-able revenue)

Schools don't need a payment gateway. The flow exists end-to-end today:

1. Outreach to GACAR Part 141 academies and operators (target list and sequence in `07-gtm/b2b-pipeline.md`).
2. Quote per the seat card above; founding-partner rate for the first 2–3.
3. Signed order → manual ZATCA-compliant e-invoice → bank transfer.
4. Grant access with the existing admin callable: `POST /api/org/:orgId/provision-seats`, then each member self-claims via `POST /api/grants/school-seat` on a verified email (`server/src/routes/`).
5. Run the customer-success lifecycle (onboarding → health → renewal) using the playbooks already in `08-customer-success/`.

Year-1 revenue logic: 10 Cohort packages at SAR 12,000 ≈ **SAR 120k ARR** — this dominates everything else until consumer checkout opens, so it gets the selling time.

Phase B — consumer pre-launch (checkout still blocked)

Keep launch mode ON, but stop giving it away silently — make the free period a **founding-member campaign**:

- Reframe the launch banner: free during launch, and joining the waitlist locks **founding-member annual at SAR 549** for the first year (first 500 members).
- Communicate the post-launch free tier *now* (library always free, 5 Adel questions/day, all 55 tools free) so the flip surprises nobody.
- Instrument what free users actually use (Adel volume, tool opens, study starts) — these numbers set the day-one conversion targets.
- Lead magnets stay free by design: Conversion Eligibility Checker, ELP Readiness Self-Check, AIP Quiz — each one ends in the matching pack CTA.

Phase C — the paywall flip (entity + Moyasar live)

Activation checklist, in order:

1. **Moyasar live (DEC-010)**: create the products at the price card above in the Moyasar dashboard; set the Moyasar API keys/secrets; verify checkout + webhook end-to-end in test mode (mada + card + Apple Pay).
2. **Gate Captain Adel first** (it is the marginal-cost item): remove `FREE_FOR_EVERYONE` in `src/lib/services/entitlements.ts` and redeploy the Cloud Run service — the server quota (5/day signed-in, 3/day anonymous, UTC day boundary, `server/src/chat-quota-core.ts`) takes over.
3. **Flip the client**: the same `FREE_FOR_EVERYONE` constant gates the UI, so the flip is one deploy. The 55 flight tools stay free and unmetered; Study, logbook and pack gating resume via

`src/lib/services/features.ts` .

4. **Protected content:** move paid payloads (quiz banks, Ground School, pack content) behind the entitlement gate, set the pack bands per `06-operations-it/runbooks/runbook-security-rollout.md` .
5. **Grandfather window:** 30 days — every existing account gets the founding-member annual (SAR 549) offer by email before quotas bite. Honour every waitlist lock.
6. Remove the launch banner from `/pricing` ; switch JSON-LD offers from `PreOrder` to `InStock` .
7. iOS: native IAP is not implemented — `src/lib/services/billing.ts` throws on the native path. Mirroring prices into store products is future work.

Revenue mix to expect (and what to build/sell first)

1. **Schools** — dominant year 1; recurring, invoice-based, sticky. Sell now.
2. **Prep Packs** — high-ticket one-time; conversion candidates buy on need, not on habit. Build content depth here second.
3. **Pro subscriptions** — compounding but slow to start; the annual push + founding-member lock accelerates it.
4. **Exam Season Pass** — seasonal; promote in the run-up to exam windows.
5. **Licensed API** — invoiced, independent of consumer checkout, and the only line that can be sold before the paywall flips.

KPIs

- Waitlist size and weekly growth (pre-launch conversion pool)
- School seats sold / active vs. licensed seats (>80% adoption target — see `08-customer-success/customer-success.md`)
- Captain Adel cost per free user per month (must stay below ~SAR 1)
- Free→paid conversion at the Adel quota wall (the single best conversion point)
- Annual share of new Pro subscriptions (target >60% — the toggle defaults to annual on purpose)

Invariants to preserve

- Entitlements are **server-only** — there is simply no route that lets a client write its own plan; nothing in this plan changes that. All grants flow through the Express routes in `server/src/routes/{billing,grants}.ts` — there is no client write path.
- Every user-facing price string is bilingual (`data-en` / `data-ar`) — `npm run check:i18n` enforces it.
- PDPL: user questions are personal data; the assistant stays on the in-Kingdom region plan regardless of monetization phase.

- Not affiliated with GACA: packs sell **preparation**, never the licence, and official fees are always stated as excluded.